

Vendor Onboarding and Data Access Policy

Northwind KnowledgeOps Group

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Sample scenario: This document supports questions about vendor due diligence, data access, onboarding gates, access reviews, and termination.

Document Purpose	This sample policy is designed for AI document ingestion, semantic retrieval, and grounded response testing in a business portal.
Review Cycle	Reviewed annually or when operating conditions, regulations, or internal controls materially change.

Quick Reference

Primary Audience	Procurement, business owners, IT security, legal, vendor managers.
Required Before Access	Approved vendor profile, signed agreement, security review, data classification review.
High-Risk Vendors	Vendors accessing confidential data or production systems require Security and Legal approval.
Access Review	Vendor access must be reviewed every ninety days.

1. Purpose

This policy establishes the controls required before a vendor may provide services, access company data, or connect to company systems.

The goal is to reduce operational, contractual, security, and privacy risks from third-party relationships.

2. Vendor Classification

Vendors are classified as standard, sensitive, or high-risk. A high-risk vendor is any vendor that processes confidential data, connects to production systems, handles payment information, or performs critical operational services.

The business owner is responsible for proposing the classification, but Procurement and Security may adjust the classification based on risk findings.

3. Onboarding Requirements

Before work begins, every vendor must have an approved vendor profile, a signed agreement, a designated business owner, and a completed procurement review.

Sensitive and high-risk vendors must also complete a security questionnaire and data classification review before receiving system access.

4. Data Access Rules

Vendor access must follow the least privilege principle. Access may only be granted to the systems, files, environments, and data fields required for the approved service.

Vendors may not store company data on personal devices, unmanaged cloud drives, or unapproved collaboration platforms.

Production system access for vendors requires approval from the business owner, IT Security, and the system owner.

5. Monitoring and Review

Vendor access must be reviewed at least every ninety days. The business owner must confirm whether access remains necessary and whether the scope is still appropriate.

Inactive vendor accounts must be disabled after thirty days of inactivity unless the business owner documents a valid operational reason.

6. Offboarding

Vendor access must be removed no later than one business day after contract termination, project completion, or notification that the vendor no longer requires access.

The business owner must confirm return or deletion of company data when required by contract or data classification rules.

Document Control: This document is a fictional sample for training, demonstration, and AI testing. It is not legal, HR, accounting, or compliance advice.